

Naming as Self-Experiment

What Is Missing When a Non-School Calls Itself the Solitary School

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Abstract

Training in a martial art is constituted by the exclusion of three things: betrayal, deception, and ambush. A training session is a state in which the partner's intent, information, and timing have all been handed to the practitioner. Withhold them and there is no training; grant them and the conditions that decide whether a technique actually works are no longer present.

Solitary training pushes this exclusion one step further. With no partner present, none of the three can occur at all. It follows that a solitary practice is structurally weak against precisely those three.

One consequence follows directly. What such a practice finally relies on is not technique. It is the capacity to prevent the situations in which the three operate from arising at all. This paper calls that capacity **strategic capability** and locates it as the terminal form of a solitary practice.

The conclusion is not derived from strength. It is derived from weakness. At the present stage it is a claim, not a measurement.

Keywords: martial arts; philosophy of practice; epistemology of skill; solitary training; self-experiment; budo

1. This Is Not a School

This paper names a structure, not a system. It holds no rank and no title. It teaches no one. It has no successor.

A martial art is verified only in front of another person. Whether a technique works is settled by whether the opponent falls. It is not something one can settle alone.

Yet most training is done alone. Forms, repetitions, breakfalls, breathing. Measured in time, solitary work dominates.

That much anyone will say. What follows is where this paper goes further: **even with a partner present, verification is not taking place.**

2. The Three Things Training Excludes

The bulk of this paper is this section.

2.1 Betrayal

The receiving partner is cooperating. They take the fall; they follow the form. That agreement is what makes training possible.

Withdraw the agreement and the object of the test disappears with it. A partner who resists in earnest is no longer a training partner. The technique "works" because the person it is applied to has undertaken to receive it. Whether the same movement produces the same result against someone who has stopped undertaking that can only be learned where the undertaking has stopped.

Training hands the practitioner the partner's **intent**.

2.2 Deception

What is coming has been announced in advance. The technique is named; the form is fixed. Even in free practice or sparring, the rules of the discipline fix the range of what may arrive.

Whether a technique passes when nothing is announced can only be learned where nothing is announced. The training hall structurally excludes the dimension of deception. It must: without that exclusion, the process of learning a technique does not function at all.

Training hands the practitioner the partner's **information**.

2.3 Ambush

There is a signal to begin. Time is given to take a stance. One bows, takes distance, and starts.

In the actual case there is no signal. That there is time to take a stance is itself a premise of training. Remove the premise and training becomes an accident.

Training hands the practitioner the partner's **timing**.

2.4 The Three Are One

These are not three separate shortcomings. They are three faces of a single thing.

Training is the state in which the partner's intent, information, and timing have all been handed over. Withhold them and there is no training. Grant them and the conditions are no longer the actual ones.

	What training grants	The actual condition
Betrayal	The partner's intent (consent to receive)	There is no consent
Deception	The partner's information (what is coming)	Nothing is announced
Ambush	The partner's timing (leisure to prepare)	There is no leisure

It follows that a technique having worked in the training hall does not mean the technique works. What worked did so under conditions in which all three had been granted.

2.5 The Doubling of the Exclusion

Train alone and there is no partner at all. Betrayal, deception, and ambush cannot occur. What the training hall excludes at one remove, solitary practice excludes at two.

From this, the reason a solitary practice cannot demonstrate its legitimacy is fixed. The reason is not that it is solitary. **It cannot be demonstrated in the training hall either.** Solitude merely takes that to its limit.

This conclusion points in a direction unfavourable to the author. It does not support "one can be finished alone." What it supports is that **the same hole is open whether one trains alone or with others.**

3. Consequence: A Solitary Practice Is Weak Against the Three

This follows directly. A solitary practice is structurally weak against the three, because it has trained only where the three were excluded.

The weakness is not filled by volume of training. More training yields more experience of conditions in which the three were excluded. No amount of excluded experience becomes experience of the unexcluded case.

4. Terminal Form: Strategic Capability

What, then, does a solitary practice finally rely on? Not technique. It relies on the capacity to prevent the situations in which the three operate from arising.

	Why technique does not solve it	What remains
Ambush	No training in responding after being struck	Do not stand where an ambush can reach
Deception	No training in seeing through deception	Do not deal with those who have a motive to deceive
Betrayal	Betrayal cannot be blocked by technique	Do not build relations in which betrayal would cost

All three lie before combat. The point is not to win. It is to prevent the situation from arising.

This paper calls that **strategic capability**. It has four components: reading a situation, taking a position, selecting whom to enter relations with, and judging when to withdraw.

This is the terminal form of a solitary practice. There is no technique beyond technique. Before technique there is the work of choosing the situation.

4.1 The Conclusion Comes from Weakness

One does not choose strategy because one is strong. One is left with it because one knows one is weak against the three. The order cannot be reversed.

It resembles the strategic thinking of the strong in outward form. The content differs. The strong choose because they can choose. Here one chooses because one cannot.

4.2 The Conclusion Is Too Convenient

Call not fighting a capacity and doing nothing turns into strength. This is blocked here by the author.

Strategic capability can be measured only by whether situations were in fact avoided. The single occasion on which avoidance failed is the whole of the measurement.

And the author holds no record of occasions on which avoidance failed, because none was kept. At the present stage, therefore, strategic capability is a claim, not a measurement.

5. Correspondence with a Prior Paper

The reason for placing this paper on the philosophical side lies in this correspondence.

	The martial side	The philosophical side
Claim	The body can be finished by solitary training	P3 — there exists a form of happiness not dependent on others
Where it is tested	Where intent, information and timing are not granted	Where others are present
Consequence	Strategic capability — not entering the situation	C2 — happiness that holds not by winning in the arena of dependence, but by not entering it
Present state	Not observed	Not observed

Both can be claimed alone and cannot be tested alone. Both choose not entering over winning. If one falls, the other is shaken.

Full text of the prior paper: [10.5281/zenodo.22058254](https://zenodo.org/record/22058254)

6. What Is Missing

This is what the title promises. There are five.

	What is missing
1	No rank. The order of attaining the highest grade in an existing lineage before founding anything has not been followed
2	No support. Since no precedent is cited, the paper contains no reason why the naming is permitted
3	No verification. Nothing has been tested under conditions in which the three are not excluded
4	No survey of prior work. There should be work in budo studies or phenomenology that has treated the same structure; it has not been consulted
5	No successor. It ends in one generation. The name may remain; the system will not

None of the five is filled. Writing that they are not filled is the work of this paper.

7. Design as a Self-Experiment

Having written "self-experiment" in the title, the design is stated. To call something an experiment without stating the design is to let the name outgrow the content.

What is tested	Whether training remains possible once any one of the three is introduced
How it is observed	It is not being observed. Observation requires another person, and once another is admitted it is no longer solitary
When it ends	Not decided. What has no end is a state, not an experiment

The second and third rows are empty. At the present stage, therefore, this is not an experiment. Only the design of one exists.

8. How to Defeat This

1. Show that training remains possible without excluding the three. Section 2 then falls.
2. Show that strategic capability remains unmeasurable. Section 4 then remains a claim only.
3. Produce prior work that has treated the same structure. The name then ceases to be a category.
4. Show that the structure differs from C2 in the prior paper. The reason for placing this on the philosophical side then disappears.

9. This Paper Is a Work in Progress

Prior work will be added as it is found.

As stated in item 4 of Section 6, there should be work in budo studies or phenomenology treating the same structure. It has simply not been consulted. At the point where such work is found, the originality of this paper is reduced by that much. The reduction will also be recorded.

Versions are kept in the git history. Records of revision are not deleted.

10. Disclaimer

This paper does not take the law lightly. The opposite.

Its conclusion is the prevention of situations. No procedure for causing harm is given, and none is needed. What follows from the premise of weakness against the three is only the conclusion of not entering the places where the three operate.

Japanese criminal law confines self-defence to acts that are unavoidable and directed against an imminent and unlawful infringement. What this paper calls strategic capability refers to **leaving before those conditions arise**. It is not a technique for fighting within them.

Weapon practice is mentioned. Neither carrying nor using weapons is encouraged. Handled outside the training hall, that becomes a matter of law.

Not entering the situations in which the law operates is placed highest. That is the opposite of taking the law lightly.

This paper is not a legal opinion. The author is not a legal professional.

Experience Relied Upon

Stated in years and place, not in grades. All of it rests on the author's own testimony.

Shinshin Toitsu Aikido	Seven years in total, in Tochigi, where the art is based. Weapon practice as well as unarmed
Kyokushin karate	A few days. Sparring with a black belt and with a former boxer
Kendo	Three years in school physical education. Took a strike to the head from an opponent at prefectural-tournament level

Not a single dan grade is held. Stating years first makes one read as standing higher than one does; that is why this is placed here. Seven years is not a number that passed any examination.

"A few days" is not deleted. A few days is a few days. Having stood across from a former boxer is not the same as having beaten one. Taking a strike to the head is a record of the one who took it.

No precedent for the act of naming is cited. To cite one would be to use another person's history as support for one's own. The support is left off.

How to Cite This

Do not upgrade it. This is not a journal article. It has not been peer-reviewed. It is a public note.

Nemoto, Takuya. "Naming as Self-Experiment: What Is Missing When a Non-School Calls Itself the Solitary School." Public note, not peer-reviewed. DOI 10.5281/zenodo.22765695. <https://github.com/cpsbvbng26-dotcom/solitary-school>

Whether that number is the concept DOI or the version DOI has not been confirmed.

Do not cite the experience table as a set of grades. It is all testimony, and no dan grade is held. The reason the naming is permitted is not given in this paper.

AI Declaration

Generative AI was used in preparing this manuscript. Anthropic's Claude (Claude Opus 5, via Claude Code) was used to draft and revise the prose, to write and run the verification scripts referred to below, and to cross-check bibliographic details. The author determined the argument — the three-part structure, the identification of intent, information and timing, and the conclusion of strategic capability — selected and verified every source, and takes full responsibility for the content, including its accuracy and originality. Claude is not an author.

A complete record of the assistance is preserved in the git history of the repository, where each commit carries a Co-Authored-By trailer.

Availability

Source, revision history, and the checks: <https://github.com/cpsbvbng26-dotcom/solitary-school>

The repository carries a checker of its own. It verifies, among other things, that the three are present, that the conclusion has not been reversed into a favourable direction, that words of rank and authority do not appear, that no other person's history is used as support, and that the disclaimer and this declaration have not been removed.

Licence

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